The Noble Dhāraṇī That Dispels Obstructors

Āryavighnavināyakadhāraṇī · Toh 959 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་བགེགས་སེལ་བའི་གཟུངས།

The Noble Dhāraṇī That Dispels Obstructors, known in Tibetan as Pakpa Gek Selwé Zung and given in its Sanskrit title line as Ārya Vighna Vināyaka Dhāraṇī, is a short incantation text centered on the deity Gaṇapati, the remover and lord of obstacles. Set at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, it records the Buddha teaching the venerable Nanda that whoever holds Gaṇapati's heart mantra will succeed in every rite, every aim, and every practice of secret mantra. The Buddha then gives the mantra itself along with simple ritual instructions, such as rising at dawn, reciting it seven times, and scattering water as an offering. The work is Toh 959 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī texts, the collection of protective and empowering spells.

In the language of India: ārya bighā bināyakāra dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī That Dispels Obstructors.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time the Blessed One said to the venerable Nanda, "Nanda, as for Gaṇapati: whoever holds the heart mantra of Gaṇapati will accomplish every rite and every aim, and will accomplish every secret mantra.

tadyathā namostute kaṭa kaṭa maṭa maṭa dara dara ṭaha ḍaha gṛhna bhañja bhañja namostute ru ru ca ca ye svāhā abhutrā bina du mkhan man ceddha parasama gcchati hahaya mahāhasti kṣatanan bragobayemo kuru kuru curu curu muru muru namo namaḥ svāhā

"Rise at dawn, recite the mantra seven times, and scatter a palmful of water upward and downward, and all obstructors will be bound. One who wishes to accomplish secret mantra should tie twenty-one knots in a white thread. If it is tied on the hand, the vidyā-mantra will be accomplished, and all obstructors will be bound. Wherever Gaṇapati appears, if one recites this mantra there even once, the obstructors will create no hindrance."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, that entire assembly rejoiced, and the world with its gods, humans, asuras and gandharvas praised what the Blessed One had said.

This completes the noble dhāraṇī called The Dispeller of Obstructors.

If one fumigates with smoke from yellow guggulu mixed with bat droppings and the droppings of the thief of all things, then even if one goes near someone sick with a contagious disease, one will not be affected. If one has been infected, it is quickly cleared. It is highly praised against the harm done by bhūtas in a household.

Translator's Notes

• The appended fumigation recipe is obscure. "Bat droppings" interprets pha bang gi rtug pa. "The thief of all things" (kun la rku ba) is most likely an epithet for the rat or mouse, and its rtag pa is taken as a variant spelling of "droppings." Both readings are tentative.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.